DESIGN CAPSULE · INDIA 2026–28

Design Capsule: Handloom quiet luxury

Chanderi, Maheshwari, khadi and tussar in calm colours, with little embellishment and beautiful cloth.

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Mood and colour

Ivory
11-0104 TCX
#F3ECDC

Sage
15-6414 TCX
#9FAE8F

Champagne gold
14-0935 TCX
#D8C08A

Dusty rose
15-1611 TCX
#D9A3A6

Pantone TCX (cotton) codes are the nearest match to the screen colour; confirm against a physical Pantone book and lab dips before production.

Why? Shoppers want pieces that feel special but can be worn again. Handloom also carries a clear sustainability story, and the government-backed khadi push keeps it visible.

What? Craft leads, ornament steps back. Designers showed handloom cotton, Chanderi, handspun khadi and tussar in loose, relaxed shapes with minimal surface work and even raw, unfinished edges.

Who's showing it?

- **AK|OK by Anamika Khanna**: Handloom cotton and Chanderi, loose drapes, raw edges
- **Péro by Aneeth Arora**: Handwoven everyday wear
- **Kartik Research**: Handspun khadi with Rabari embroidery

Key pieces

The key pieces with reference photos, ready to brief into design.



Pastel handloom sarees

RISING

Dusty rose, powder blue and lavender on handloom bases.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Rising	Peaking	Peaking	Peaking

Festive 28
Fading



Straight kurta with band collar

PEAKING

Straight kurtas with a Nehru (band) collar and churidar or straight trousers.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Peaking	Peaking	Peaking	Peaking

Festive 28
Peaking



Linen kurta sets

RISING

Breathable linen and cotton-silk for relaxed celebrations.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Rising	Peaking	Peaking	Peaking

Festive 28
Fading



Tone-on-tone embroidery

RISING

Embroidery in the fabric colour for quiet luxury.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Rising	Peaking	Peaking	Peaking

Festive 28
Fading



Chanderi

PEAKING

Light, sheer Madhya Pradesh weave for kurtas, sarees and jackets.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Peaking	Peaking	Peaking	Peaking

Festive 28
Peaking



Raw, unfinished edges

EMERGING

Deliberately unfinished edges, as shown by AK|OK.

Festive 26	Summer 27	Festive 27	Summer 28
Emerging	Rising	Rising	Peaking

Festive 28
Peaking

Price guide (India)

KEY GARMENT	VALUE	MID	PREMIUM
Handloom kurta set	₹1,499–2,999	₹3,500–8,000	₹15,000+
Chanderi or Maheshwari saree	₹1,999–3,999	₹5,000–12,000	₹25,000+
Linen or khadi men's kurta	₹999–1,999	₹2,500–5,000	₹9,000+

Cost to make: Medium. True handloom has longer lead times and minimums. Use handloom for hero pieces and powerloom Chanderi-look or cotton-silk for value ranges.

How to build the capsule

- Build a calm-colour handloom capsule: kurta sets, sarees and men's kurtas.
- Swap heavy embroidery for tone-on-tone work at the neckline and cuffs.
- Tell the weave and cluster story on the label and product page.

Range plan

Lead with three or four hero handloom fabrics and a simple, modern silhouette. Price the capsule in the mid to premium band and tell the weaver and region story on every product page.

- **Hero pieces (about 20%):** the strongest expression of the story, at higher prices.
- **Core pieces (about 60%):** easy-to-wear styles in the capsule colours.
- **Add-ons (about 20%):** accessories and layers that increase basket size.

Selling it in different regions

In India, time the capsule to the festive or summer window it suits. For South Asian communities abroad, link it to local festival dates and weddings. For international customers new to Indian fashion, lead with easy pieces such as shirts, jackets and scarves, and explain the craft.

Common questions

Why is handloom seen as luxury? It is slower to make, carries regional craft and has a natural texture that machine-made cloth cannot copy.

Which customers buy it? Customers who value craft, natural fibres and long-lasting pieces, in India and internationally.

Sources: Free Press Journal and Harper's Bazaar India, Lakmé Fashion Week 2026; Aza Fashions, ethnic trends 2026.